

Catalytic Impact of Early Investments in Advanced Clean Energy Technologies

Kick-off

PyPSA Labs, Google

September 2026



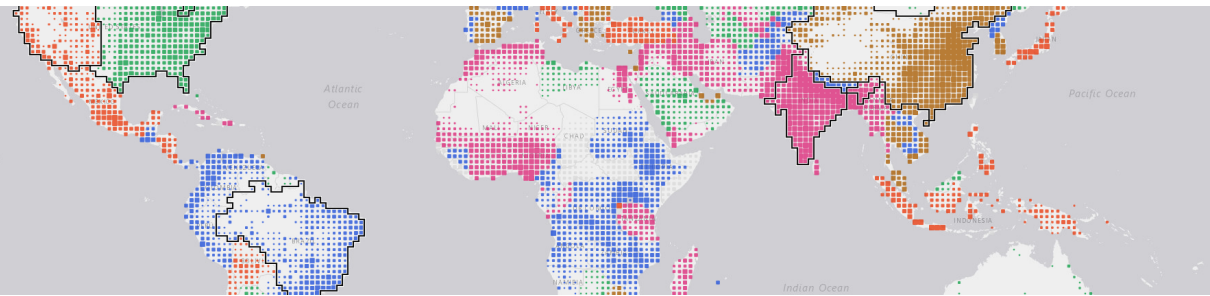
Project overview

Goal

- Quantifying the catalytic impact of early investment into advanced clean technologies:
Experience curves, emission reduction,
global addressable market

Approach

- Model representative power systems from today to mid-century in PyPSA
- Measure the impact of early investment onto late, *catalysed* runs



Today

- Modelled regions
- Technologies
- Technology learning

Modelled regions and grid archetypes



Fast-growing

☐ modelled: India



Sparse, slow growing

☐ modelled: United States (East)



Dense, slow growing

☐ modelled: China



Geothermal-favourable

☐ modelled: United States (West)



Clean incumbents (hydro & nuclear)

☐ modelled: Brazil

Modelled regions and grid archetypes



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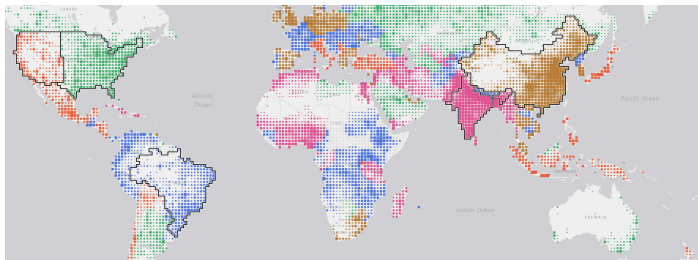
Geothermal-favourable

☐ modelled: United States (West)

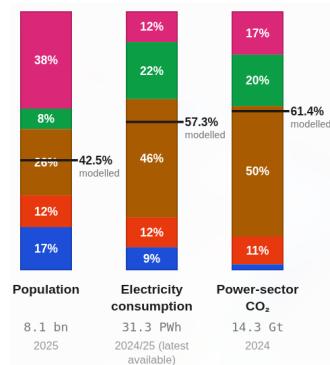
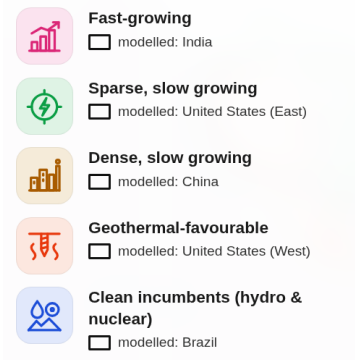


Clean incumbents (hydro & nuclear)

☐ modelled: Brazil



Modelled regions and grid archetypes



Technologies

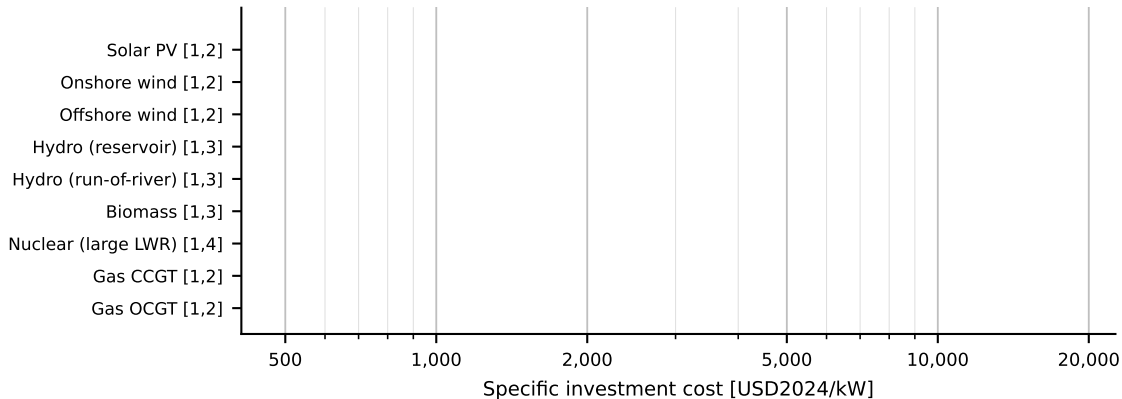
Mature: exogenous costs

- Solar PV, onshore/offshore wind
- Hydro: reservoir, run-of-river, pumped hydro
- Biomass
- Nuclear (large LWR)
- Gas CCGT and OCGT
- Li-ion battery

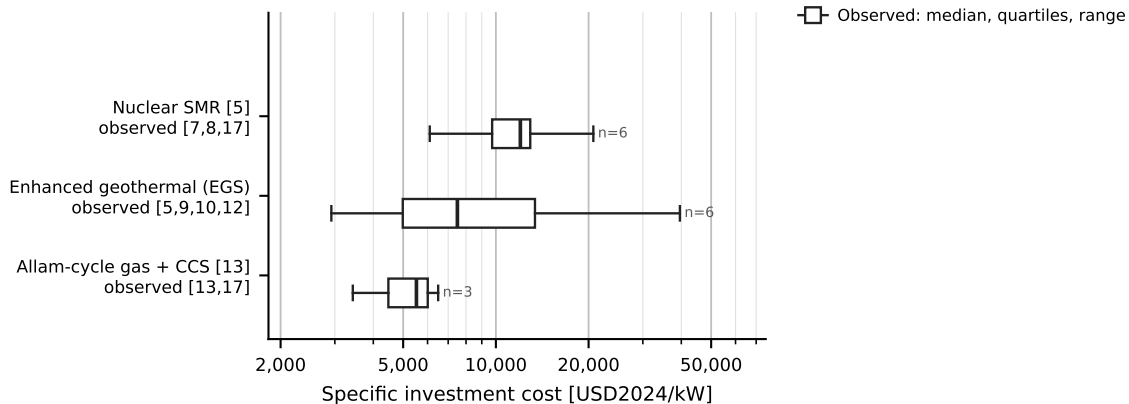
Advanced: endogenous learning

- LDES: vanadium flow, CO₂ battery, iron-air, H₂ + SOFC
- Nuclear SMR
- Next-gen geothermal: EGS, closed-loop
- Allam-cycle gas + CCS
- Solid oxide fuel cell
- Fusion (with caution)
- CDR: direct air capture, cost cut-off

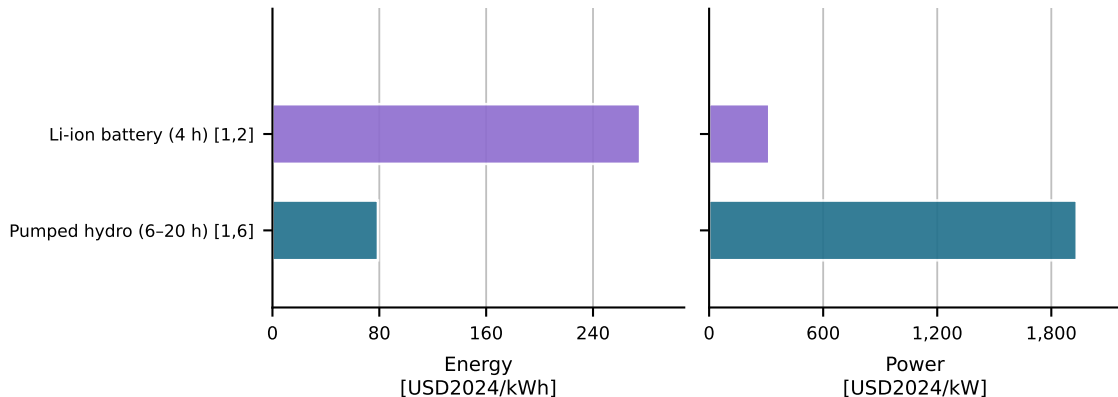
2025 capex baseline: mature generation



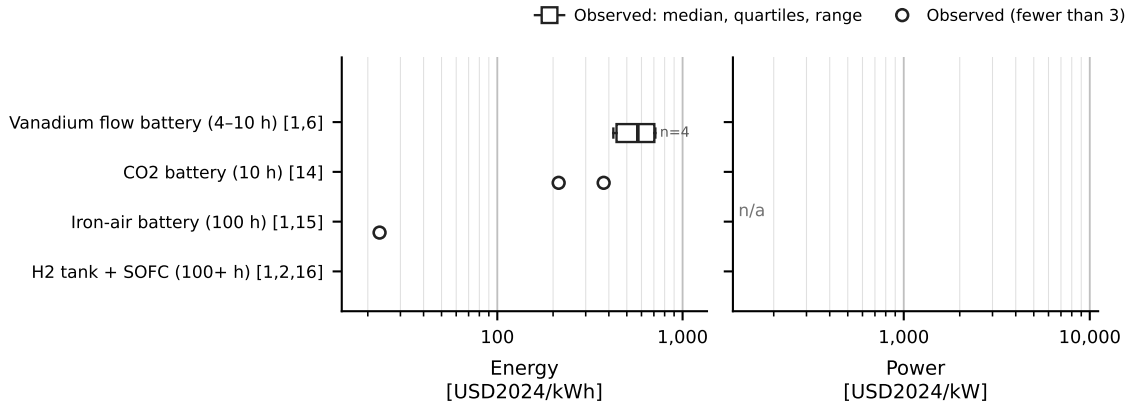
2025 capex baseline: advanced generation



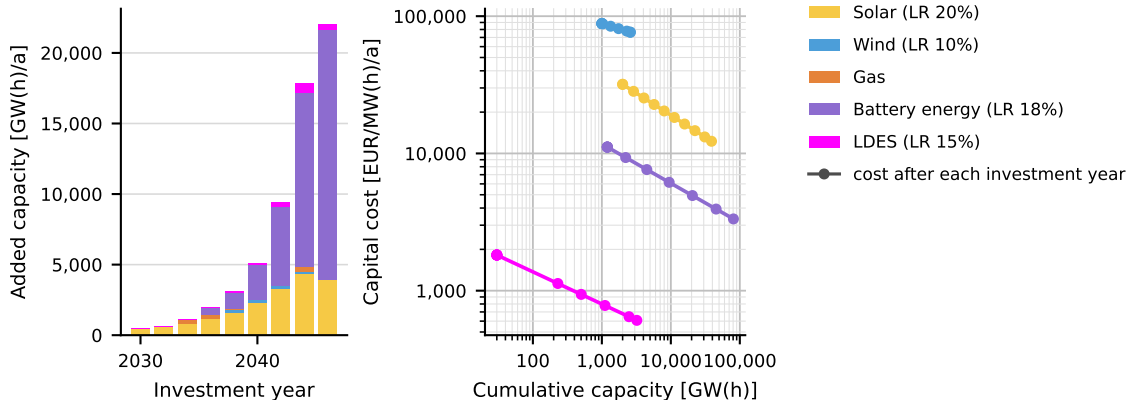
2025 capex baseline: mature storage



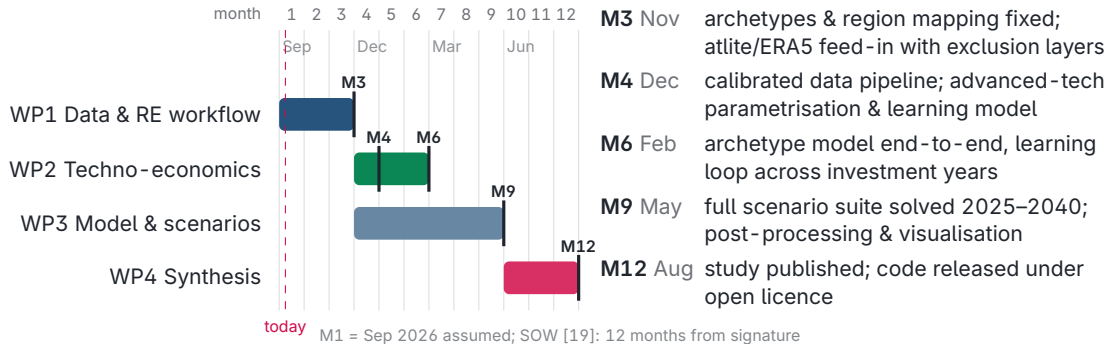
2025 capex baseline: advanced storage



Endogenous learning in the world model (prototype)



SOW work packages and milestones



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- [18] T. Brown, priam-myopic: myopic world electricity model with endogenous learning (prototype, 2026) github.com
- [19] PyPSA Labs and Google, Statement of Work: Catalytic Impact of Early Investments in Advanced Clean Energy Tech (2026)

Frame title

DEMONSTRATION

Text with **alerted text**, the accents green, red, gray and chips that highlight quietly or loudly [1].

- First item of an itemisation
 - Second item with **bold** text
 - Third item with a [hyperlink](#)
-
- 1 First item of an enumeration
 - 2 Second item of an enumeration

Block

Uses the primary brand colour.

Example block

Uses the green accent.

Alert block

Uses the red accent.

Consider a total system cost minimisation problem¹:

$$\min_{g_{s,t}, G_s} \quad \overbrace{\sum_s c_s G_s}^{\text{investment costs}} + \overbrace{\sum_{s,t} o_s g_{s,t}}^{\text{fuel costs}} \quad \text{s.t.}$$

$$\sum_s g_{s,t} - d_t = 0 \quad \perp \quad \lambda_t \quad \text{(nodal energy balance)}$$

The dual variable λ_t of the energy balance is the **market price**.

¹Assume the investment costs are annualised.

A statement slide for one idea.

1. Brown, T., Hörsch, J. & Schlachtberger, D. PyPSA: Python for Power System Analysis. *Journal of Open Research Software* 6. doi:[10.5334/jors.188](https://doi.org/10.5334/jors.188) (2018).

Get in touch

Firstname Lastname

Role or position

name@pypsalabs.org

pypsalabs.org

REFERENCES



PyPSA Labs gGmbH, Mertensstr. 16A, 13587 Berlin, Germany · District Court Charlottenburg
HRB 288490 B · Managing Directors: Prof. Dr. Thomas William Brown & Dr.-Ing. Fabian Neumann
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